## Rules for working with hot food

Ensure all food is thoroughly cooked to a minimum core temperature of 75°C. If stored hot, maintain the temperature above 63°C. Only reheat food once to 82°C for immediate consumption. Keep hot food covered.



The time between:

*refrigeration and cooking (or processing);*

*cooking and eating;*

*cooking and refrigeration; and*

*refrigeration and serving* must be kept as short as possible.

NB - when checking temperatures, clean and disinfect the probe thermometer between different foods.

Never probe **RAW FOOD** then **HIGH-RISK FOOD.**



## Serving of food

**K**eep hot food hot and cold food cold.

**K**eep the time between cooking and serving to a minimum.

**S**eparate raw and ready-to-eat foods.

**K**eep food covered and minimise handling.

**O**bserve good hygiene practices.

**E**nsure high standards of cleanliness.

**P**rotect food from customers.



# Food safety law

**R**egulation (EC) No. 852/2004 on the Hygiene of Foodstuffs deals with hygiene standards of food premises, food equipment and food handlers, including training requirements.

**T**he Food Safety and Hygiene (England) (Scotland) (Wales) (Northern Ireland) Regulations deal with enforcement and temperature control.



**T**he Food Safety Act 1990 deals with food standards.

## Due diligence

**Due diligence** may be used as a defence in the event of prosecution under food safety legislation. It involves taking all reasonable precautions to avoid committing the offence.



Satisfactory records are important to support a **due-diligence defence.**

## After cleaning

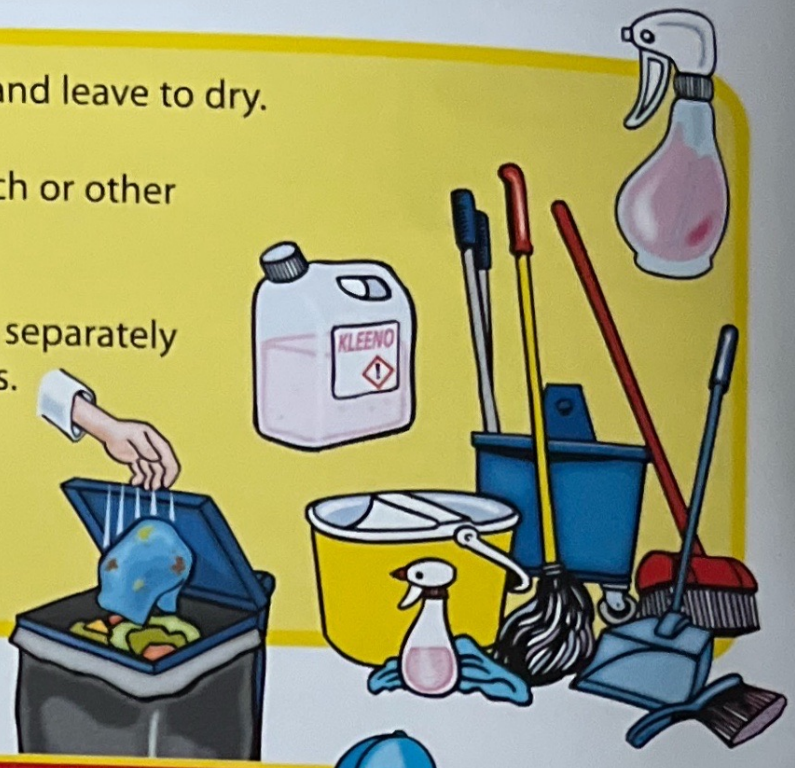
**C**lean and disinfect cleaning equipment and leave to dry.

**D**o not store cleaning equipment in bleach or other disinfectant overnight.

**S**tore cleaning equipment and chemicals separately from food, preferably in locked cupboards.

**T**hrow disposable cloths away.

**W**ash your hands.




## Clear-and-clean-as-you-go

**To reduce the risk of contamination, you should keep work areas clean and tidy. Don't let waste food and dirty equipment build up. Remove spillages and waste packaging immediately.**



## Six-stage cleaning



## When to wash your hands - *keep yourself clean and food safe*

**CRITICAL**

**Before** entering a food room/handling food
**After** using the toilet
**After** handling a first aid dressing
**After** handling soiled nappies or clothing
**After** handling contaminated packaging
**After** dealing with a person suffering from diarrhoea or vomiting
**After** cleaning up animal accidents
**After** handling raw food
**Before** handling ready-to-eat food



**IMPORTANT**

**After** cleaning
**After** combing your hair
**After** blowing your nose
**After** handling waste
***And*** often throughout the day

## How to wash your hands - *keep yourself clean and food safe*




*Wet hands thoroughly*




*Use liquid soap*




*Rub hands vigorously...*




*..especially the nails and the fingertips*




*Rub the thumbs*




*Rinse hands thoroughly*




*Use paper towel to dry completely*




*Turn off tap using the paper towel*

## Whilst in a food room or handling open food

### You must not:

**S**moke.

**S**cratch your head.

**T**ouch your mouth or nose or bite your fingernails, eat sweets, chew gum or taste food with an unwashed spoon or your fingers.

**H**andle ready-to-eat food unnecessarily.

**W**ear jewellery, nail varnish or strong smelling perfume/aftershave.

**B**low into glasses or handle the parts of plates or equipment which come into direct contact with ready-to-eat food.



### You must:

**W**ash your hands properly before starting work.

**C**over cuts with a detectable waterproof dressing.

**K**eep fingernails short and clean.

**R**emove protective clothing when using the WC or leaving the food premises.

**T**urn away from food or work surfaces to cough or sneeze into the upper arm or shoulder.

**W**ear strong sensible shoes.

**U**se a clean paper tissue to blow your nose. Then wash your hands.



**Do not wear protective clothing outside the food premises**

## DO's and DON'Ts of cleaning:

### You must:

**F**ollow instructions, for example, the cleaning schedule.
Plan cleaning so that high-risk areas are cleaned first.
Use protective clothing.

**R**emove or cover all food.

**S**tart at the top and work down.

**U**se the correct cleaning chemicals and equipment.

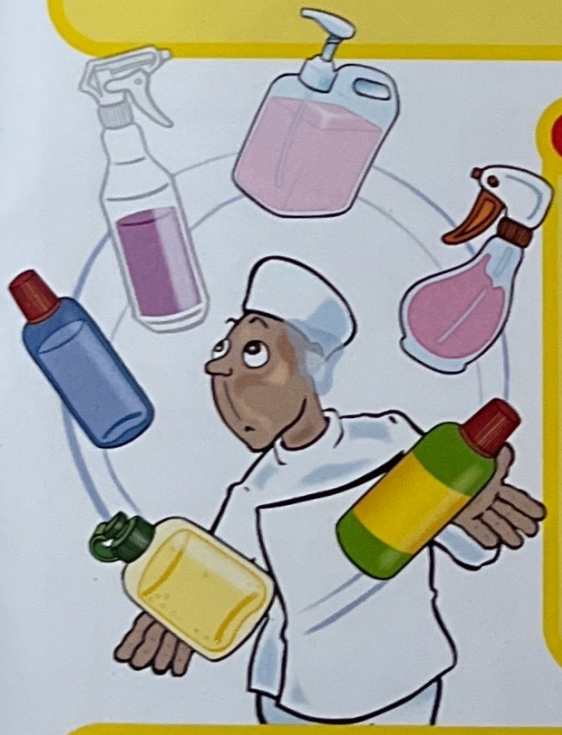
**P**ay particular attention to hand-contact surfaces such as handles on refrigerators.

**C**hange water which becomes cool or dirty.

**R**eport defective or damaged equipment, shortage of chemicals or absence of protective clothing.

**E**mpty waste bins regularly throughout the day and always at the end of the day.



### You must not:

**M**ix chemicals.

**U**se washbasins for washing equipment.

**P**lay about with chemicals or cleaning equipment.

**T**ransfer chemicals to unmarked or food containers.

**U**se the same equipment for cleaning WCs and food rooms.




**Poor cleaning will result in contaminated food:**
Wiping cloths spread contamination from one surface to another.